KALE REALTY

AFFORDABILITY KILLS MORE DEALS THAN ANYTHING.

Agents picked it over every other reason, by more than two to one.

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NAR ASKED REALTORS WHAT ACTUALLY STOPS A SALE. ONE ANSWER WON BY MORE THAN DOUBLE.

27% of agents picked affordability. Lack of inventory came in at just 12%.

03 / 05

THAT'S AGENTS TALKING, NOT BUYERS.

NAR's 2026 Member Profile asked brokerage specialists, not buyers, to name the single biggest thing stopping their own clients from closing. Affordability topped the list at 27%, more than double the next two reasons combined: lack of inventory at 12% and trouble finding the right property at 11%. Agents are watching deals die over the payment, not the price tag or the search.

WHAT THAT CHANGES ABOUT YOUR NEXT BUYER CONVERSATION:

1 **Run the payment math before the showing.**
If affordability is what kills deals, the conversation that saves one happens before the home search starts, not during it.

2 **Know every buydown and down-payment program cold.**
The agents closing in this market are the ones who can talk through real options on the spot, not refer out and lose momentum.

3 **Say the real number out loud, early.**
A buyer who hears their actual monthly payment in week one makes fewer offers they can't really afford.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Before your next buyer tour, run their real numbers first. The agents who do that are the ones who don't lose the deal to affordability.

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